

Speaker1: [00:00:02] Hum. So how would you like us to refer to your partner? Boyfriend, spouse, partner? Is there a particular name?

Speaker2: [00:00:12] Um, I often just say.

Speaker1: [00:00:16] My companion, your companion, very well. How long have you been with your companion?

Speaker2: [00:00:20] It's going to be [1-5] years.

Speaker1: [00:00:22] Very well, it's going to be [1-5] years. Listen, first of all, I'd like you to simply tell me about the love story you're living and your current relationship with your companion.

Speaker2: [00:00:33] Well, I can name her too.

Speaker1: [00:00:36] Of course, you can name her.

Speaker2: [00:00:38] Um. So actually, we met on a site, and I met her after a breakup. Actually, I had lived with someone for [6-10] years and I ended it. So there you go, I wanted to, actually. After [1-5] months, I decided to try to meet someone. But I didn't want anything serious, actually. And so I signed up on a site. I won't name it because it's not interesting, but I signed up without really believing in it, actually. For me, it was a site that didn't have much value, so I wasn't necessarily looking to really meet someone, actually. So, I signed up anyway and I got a few contacts, um. And there was [Partner's Name], and [Partner's Name] right away. At first, she hadn't put her picture, she had put her picture but not, how can I say, what she looked like. When I met her, she had long hair, while in the photo it was very short. And I didn't look at that, I looked at her eyes, let's say. And actually, at first, what bothered me a bit was the age difference.

Speaker2: [00:01:54] For me it was too significant. And so I didn't. I replied but without really thinking it would lead to anything. But then, well, it's not that [Partner's Name] insisted, but um. We had a first date and well, we never parted. In short. So, as both of us didn't believe in it either and I was coming out of a breakup. I didn't want someone to be a rebound either. That's why I didn't want someone regular, let's say. And um. Well, actually, love can't be controlled, actually. So, I knew right away that I was in love with her. [Partner's Name] not necessarily at first, uh. And then it's been [1-5] years, we are considering living together now, someone who comes after won't come back. Um. I don't know if there's anything else you want me to say, but.

Speaker1: [00:03:07] Please. So, you said you weren't really looking to meet someone?

Speaker2: [00:03:11] No, actually, in a way, I wanted to have fun. I didn't want something serious right away, let's say. That's it.

Speaker1: [00:03:20] You wanted to have fun.

Speaker2: [00:03:22] In quotes, yes, I wanted to have fun, but I didn't have fun.

Speaker1: [00:03:28] You also talked about the fact, you said neither of us believed in it either.

Speaker2: [00:03:34] Uh no, because [Partner's Name] was there by chance too. She didn't necessarily want to meet someone either. And then, well, there you go, it was more of a challenge compared to another person who registered as a challenge. Yeah, a challenge. That's it. That is to say, uh. She said that a friend of hers had told her to register on this site. She said, I'll sign up, I'll find someone. It was just. It wasn't planned for her either.

Speaker1: [00:04:09] You also talked about the age difference.

Speaker2: [00:04:15] We have a [11-15] age gap, and actually, in my values, it's like that, that's how I was raised. For me, the age gap is almost a generational gap. For me, it means complications in the sense that we don't have the same. Generational gaps, actually. I thought we wouldn't listen to the same music, she wouldn't have the same tastes, the same references, etc, etc. But no, not at all. It wasn't something. Uh. Complicated. There you go.

Speaker1: [00:05:01] No, it wasn't something complicated, no? Hum. You also talked about? You said you were in love right away and she not necessarily.

Speaker2: [00:05:18] No, because she didn't necessarily want to commit either. For her, a person isn't meant to live with the same person all their life. Which I. I would say I agree with her opinion actually. It's clear. I was married for [26-30] years to a man, [6-10] years with another woman. For me, because I got married the first time, for me, it was for life. But I don't know what I was going to say actually. Hum. For her, relationships only last [1-5] years. We are starting to talk about our projects now actually. So.

Speaker1: [00:06:09] You said you agreed with her opinion.

Speaker2: [00:06:12] Yes yes, because yes it's true that we can't say, we can't say, even if we think about it, that we are meant to live a whole life with one person. Yeah.

Speaker1: [00:06:25] You told me. Sorry, I heard you. I'm listening.

Speaker2: [00:06:29] Because I experienced it. I thought it was for life with my husband, but actually no. So I have to agree with her.

Speaker1: [00:06:40] Uh. You told me a bit about how you met, that is, you met on a site, then you saw each other, how did it go? Can you tell me?

Speaker2: [00:06:53] Oh yes, I can tell you? Um no, it's me. How can I say. I had just met someone else the week before, I was talking with a friend, so I was supposed to meet this person and I said I was going to meet her because I preferred to see you. She told me no, go ahead, go ahead. So I met this person and actually when we introduced ourselves, I wasn't ready at all. I was in the worst conditions actually. Almost badly dressed. Uh meal while usually I

cook very well, but really, I received very poorly. And I'm not proud today, but I think I was a bit lost and I didn't necessarily believe [Partner's Name] would come to me. There you go. And um. We spent the whole weekend together, there you go. Hum.

Speaker1: [00:07:52] You didn't necessarily believe in it.

Speaker2: [00:07:54] Oh no, no no, I didn't believe in it. No, no, it's um. Well, actually there you go, I was coming out of a complicated story. Um. [Partner's Name] had just gotten her license, had never driven alone for more than [1-5] hours at night to actually bring me cigarettes because I didn't have any more cigarettes. It was [Day], there you go. Hum. I thought if someone brings me cigarettes on a [Day] night, there's something there.

Speaker1: [00:08:24] You said. You told me you weren't proud of having received her that way and that you were a bit off.

Speaker2: [00:08:35] Because she sometimes brings it up again.

Speaker1: [00:08:38] She brings it up again. Hum hum. So you stayed together the whole weekend? How did it evolve after that?

Speaker2: [00:08:49] Well, actually, we continued to communicate, to see each other regularly. And then I spent almost, let's say, [1-5] years at her place, almost forgetting my apartment. Then I had health issues. I had knee surgeries, shoulder surgeries. [Partner's Name] lived in a [1-5]-floor apartment, well, on the [first-fifth] floor, without an elevator, it became complicated. So I moved back to my apartment, let's say. Hum. And so right now, what we are doing. I share [Partner's Name] with her children in shared custody [1-5] week out of [1-5]. And there you go. But we realize that we really need to live together actually, or at least cohabit. I don't want to say we need each other, we complement each other, not even complement, it's yes it's for us, but it becomes a necessity.

Speaker1: [00:09:57] A necessity.

Speaker2: [00:09:58] Yes, yes, really. Because when we are apart, we worry about each other. Yeah.

Speaker1: [00:10:10] So if I understand correctly, you lived together after [1-5] years and a half, then because of your surgeries it became complicated, you moved back to your place. And so [Partner's Name] has children, and you see her about [1-5] week out of [1-5], right? Or do you live together [1-5] week out of [1-5]? If you had to compare the quality of your relationship with that of your friends, what could you say?

Speaker2: [00:10:44] With that of my friends. Compare. I usually don't compare, but. What I know is that my friends, the people who see us, feel the love between us. There you go. Other than that, comparing is not necessarily. What interests me is our relationship. It's not necessarily that of others. Can I smoke?

Speaker1: [00:11:20] It doesn't bother me at all. Make yourself comfortable.

Speaker2: [00:11:25] After [1-5] years. I could compare with my own stories, but not with others' stories actually.

Speaker1: [00:11:34] Please, you can indeed compare with your own stories. If you had to compare the quality of your current relationship with that of your previous relationships, what could you say?

Speaker2: [00:11:41] The last one is always the best, for me anyway. Why? Because I. I don't know how to explain it actually. [Partner's Name] is really someone. I'm not going to say like me. Who has no malice. And I know that even if it can happen to her, like me too, that we hurt each other with words or things like that, it's not intentional, it's not there is no malice. There is something pure, there you go.

Speaker1: [00:12:21] Something pure. That's something you didn't have in your previous relationships, no?

Speaker2: [00:12:28] Always an interest in my previous relationships, actually.

Speaker1: [00:12:32] Always an interest. You said yes.

Speaker2: [00:12:35] Yes, yes, absolutely. My ex told me I invested in you. Well I thought. I stayed with you because you have a lot of capabilities etc. Clearly.

Speaker1: [00:12:48] I'm not sure I understand what that means. By interest. Investing in the other. What does that mean?

Speaker2: [00:13:02] Investing.

Speaker1: [00:13:03] Investing in the other. What does that mean?

Speaker2: [00:13:07] By interest.

Speaker1: [00:13:09] Rather, yes, by interest.

Speaker2: [00:13:14] Ah, if I had to, I'm going to create a company. Well, it's still a project, but health issues. So there you go, after that. Well, it was a bad relationship, that's all.

Speaker1: [00:13:27] If I understand correctly, you compare and contrast being with someone for love and for interest, which is not love. Right? So if I understand correctly, again, the relationship you had previously was a relationship where there was no love or at least not in the same form.

Speaker2: [00:13:48] On one side, let's say.

Speaker1: [00:13:50] On your side, okay. And you mentioned that you had [1-5] relationships, right, before?

Speaker2: [00:14:00] Yes, I was married to the father of my children for [26-30] years.

Speaker1: [00:14:04] Regarding that relationship. Can you tell me about it?

Speaker2: [00:14:07] Well, it's, it's exactly, exactly. It's not quite the same because I will always have respect for the father of my children. Um. But um. Actually clearly, I made a mistake in gender already, so um, I didn't make a mistake and um. Above all, I realized late that I loved women and I wanted children and for me, I was taught that to have children, you need a man. Uh it's, it's the education I had, let's say catholic education, because I had never heard of women with women or men with men, etc. I discovered that actually while working. Clearly, it's a colleague from the office who told me I would like to have an experience with a woman. Go ahead, I don't know why we got on the subject. Actually, she told me it's with you that I want to do it. And I said no, it's not possible, I'm married. There you go. After that, I can tell you why I left my husband too. Why? Because I realized, because it developed actually, this proposition. And actually I realized yes, that actually I was always surrounded by female friends uh. And that. So actually yes, it's women that I like. It's not necessarily the. And I waited. Actually, when I had children, I waited [6-10] years. I talked about it for [6-10] years before leaving my husband so that my children would be older, a bit older. And tell him that it was over, that I was going to leave him. He was warned. For him, it was a whim, etc. And so when? I didn't decide. But when I thought my children were old enough, I told him, now we are breaking up, we are divorcing. There you go. And um, we divorced without me. I hadn't met any woman. I didn't leave for someone. That's part of my values. It's.

Speaker1: [00:16:48] So in what you are telling me indeed at the beginning, you highlighted the purity of your current relationship where there is no malice but also the love you could feel. Which is quite understandable considering your life path. Would you say in the same way that in your first relationship or rather was there this love you are talking about or is it the first time that you have this kind of love for someone?

Speaker2: [00:17:18] No? I would say in this way for the first time with my husband. The complicity actually. There you go, it wasn't. I wasn't fulfilled, I wasn't. And for me it has to be a whole, it has to be, it has to be. Um as [Partner's Name] often tells me, I want to be the woman of my life and I want you to be the woman of your life. Hum. Hum.

Speaker1: [00:17:41] Would you say you are fulfilled now?

Speaker2: [00:17:43] Oh yes, yes, completely.

Speaker1: [00:17:45] Completely.

Speaker2: [00:17:48] But there are obstacles.

Speaker1: [00:17:51] There are always obstacles. Tell me more about these obstacles, tell me more about these obstacles you mentioned.

Speaker2: [00:18:05] The fact that we agreed to live together and then I couldn't stay at her place. My place was too small to accommodate everyone. But then. So finally, it's technical, but I've been fighting for [1-5] years, for [1-5] years against water damage. And now I hope to get. And it's precisely today that I think things will change. Why today? Because there are early mayoral elections and it's someone I worked with. A few years ago. A long time ago, who I know very well who should normally be elected, who promised to support me, but I don't necessarily need it. I'm in court with my landlord and we really want. So we said even if it doesn't work out, we will before [Month], we will we will live together. It's not.

Speaker1: [00:19:05] I'd like you to tell me what a high-quality relationship means to you.

Speaker2: [00:19:11] Trust. Love, of course. Being attentive to the other. And making the other happy too. Making the other happy too, it's important, it's respect. Respect. Uh understanding is.

Speaker1: [00:19:40] So a quality relationship is an understanding relationship.

Speaker2: [00:19:46] Uh, among other things, yes. Well, it's not just that.

Speaker1: [00:19:49] But uh. How can you know then that you are in an understanding relationship? You also told me respect.

Speaker2: [00:19:59] Trust. When there are no disputes, few disputes. That's important.

Speaker1: [00:20:06] Disputes are important.

Speaker2: [00:20:08] Oh yes, not at all. Because I think that even if there are annoyances or uh. Uh. Because.

Speaker1: [00:20:37] Differences.

Speaker2: [00:20:38] Yes, let's say it like that. There were disagreements or the way to find a solution is to talk actually, that's all. Communication is also important. Hum. It's not turning your back and sulking or things like that. For me, communication is important. So yes, communication is also important.

Speaker1: [00:21:06] When would you say your current relationship was the most communicative?

Speaker2: [00:21:19] Hum. Pffff. Because we talk a lot, actually a lot, even if there are things that, uh, that bother us and we talk about it, we try to understand why it bothers one or the other. I know that I for example, I like going out, I like seeing friends, etc. [Partner's Name] needs to rest. So I completely understand. I respect that. Actually, it's also something that was

complicated at first because she needs a lot of sleep. At first I thought she was bored with me. Not at all. After [1-5] years, I manage to understand all that too.

Speaker1: [00:22:03] So when was it the least communicative?

Speaker2: [00:22:16] The least. Yes, it was the [first-fifth] year when we were together all the time.

Speaker1: [00:22:22] You were together all the time, but it was the least communicative relationship.

Speaker2: [00:22:27] That's it. Because there were her children and it's not a problem with the children. But. It was complicated because I was there, so I told her you can, you can do things with them and she thought I'm here. So it has to be also that but not at all, I uh At first it was Yes, it was a bit complicated, it was a bit complicated. So we didn't necessarily talk because the children were not far and uh there you go, I don't know how. What more to say about that, but. It's true that we understand each other better and better. Not because the children are not there. It has nothing to do with it because. But the [1st-5th] year also, you have to be accepted, you have to integrate. And for me, I loved her children right away, just like she loves mine. So there you go. After, as we say, the walls have ears, we can't talk about everything and anything when we are not alone.

Speaker1: [00:23:40] You also talked about respect. When would you say again that your relationship was the most respectful?

Speaker2: [00:23:49] Precisely in terms of her need to rest, uh her need also Because it's normal, huh, uh to have uh privileged moments with her children. So I completely respect that. Hum uh uh. I was even ready to tell her until we have a house, you, you, you, we don't see each other anymore, we go back. But uh. Because actually, when she comes here at first, a bit less now, she told me yes but then I miss time with my children, I don't say no, but at that moment we stay at your place all the time. Uh she understood that no because well uh, somehow well uh. Even if she is not with her children, uh uh we make sure that there are no worries. Uh. Yes. There you go, it's uh. Uh I don't know. After that, I don't know what else to say.

Speaker1: [00:25:02] Make sure there are no worries.

Speaker2: [00:25:04] Yes yes, well, it's mostly administrative.

Speaker1: [00:25:08] Administrative.

Speaker2: [00:25:11] Uh. I don't know if I can talk about it but [redacted].

Speaker1: [00:26:42] Being together allows you to avoid everyday problems.

Speaker2: [00:26:47] Papers here and there, all that, it's. If it's uh, there you go, uh and then uh, having stability. Uh yes, because it's complicated [1-5] years, [1-5] years of going back and forth. It's true. It's complicated.

Speaker1: [00:27:15] I heard what you said. You told me what a high-quality relationship is for you. Now I'd like you to tell me what a low-quality relationship is for you.

Speaker2: [00:27:26] Low quality! Uh. It's not caring about anyone actually. I think that. It's thinking only about oneself. Well, you have to be a bit selfish, but it's uh it's living the moments intensely, even if we are only together [1-5] week out of [1-5]. But. For me, yes, especially the last one, even if we don't do much, for me, it's intense. I feel it that way, actually. Hum.

Speaker1: [00:28:11] So a low-quality relationship for you is. It's something.

Speaker2: [00:28:19] In general low-quality relationships. I don't know what I could say, but actually, for me, it doesn't last. If? For me, from the moment it starts to last over time, for me it's not of low quality. Well, I don't know how. It's quality. It's. I don't know. It's that the person is not well and neither is the other. Hum. There are things that don't work, so you shouldn't be in a couple just to be in a couple or have children just to have children.

Speaker1: [00:28:56] How can you know? That you're not well with the person either, that you're in such a relationship. How can you know?

Speaker2: [00:29:02] Ah but it's that you're not fulfilled, it's that you're not smiling, it's that you're not doing what you want to do, it's that there you go. I don't know, I. Uh. That you feel empty. I don't know.

Speaker1: [00:29:24] [Participant's Name], what interests me is your own perception of things. Really. I can't take the time, that's why. I'm here. We are discussing to know what you think about all these things. Well, you told me a bit, or rather a lot about what a high or low-quality relationship is for you. I'd also like you to tell me what the most important things are for you in a romantic relationship.

Speaker2: [00:29:54] I'm going to go back a bit to what I said earlier. So it's respect, it's freedom for each person, it's important. It's keeping one's activities. If at first, I thought it was good to do activities together. Because I didn't conceive actually, the fact that there were no common points. Actually, we have a lot of common points, except that for now, we can't really do them together. Uh before, somehow, I forbade myself a bit to do my activities. Uh now no, I. I go as how to say. I felt uh.

Speaker3: [00:30:39] Uh.

Speaker2: [00:30:40] I thought if I can't be with her in my activities or hers, there's a problem. But actually no, no, I play poker for example, I play poker and uh well I realize she likes it. Well uh I think that I play poker better, but it's not a relationship problem, it's a fatigue problem. Uh actually I don't forbid myself that anymore. Actually I. Because if I'm me, if I'm not happy on the

side, she will feel me unhappy and it's not the solution either. So uh, I took back. Everything I liked to do, not yet completely. And uh. And the fact that we are together, of course, it will help us also to do her activities. Uh. Because it takes her a bit more time. Uh precisely to do something stable she started to do sports, but she can't tell me, you know, it's complicated, it's even. Very complicated.

Speaker1: [00:31:51] So for you, the important things are what you gave me there. It's freedom.

Speaker2: [00:31:57] Among others, yes, yes, yes.

Speaker1: [00:31:59] Freedom and especially the realization of being happy, of taking your space to then be together. Right?

Speaker2: [00:32:12] Exactly.

Speaker1: [00:32:15] You talked to me a bit earlier, there, in the. In the interview. I saw you smile. Is there something you wanted to add?

Speaker3: [00:32:27] No, no, no, no.

Speaker2: [00:32:27] I'm listening, I'm waiting. I make.

Speaker1: [00:32:29] Certain. Don't hesitate really. Don't hesitate to. You talked to me a bit earlier in the interview about love, pure love or maybe sometimes interested love, or love that is maybe not as pure as we think. I'd like you to talk to me again relying on your experience about what love is for you.

Speaker2: [00:32:56] So for me it's I was going to say having children and no, it's all this, it's uh, it won't be possible for us both, that's for sure. Uh but for me love is still living together, it's sharing certain things. It's respect respect for her ideas, for uh, uh, her way of being, uh I'm speaking in both directions, of course. Hum for me, I have values, for me it's also marriage, it's not necessarily to party or anything like that. For me it's part of a commitment. There you go. So. I always have. Well there you go, it's part of me, it's like that. I don't know why. It's not to imprison someone or anything like that. It's really a recognition. Full of love. After, maybe I'm still in the old school, but. There you go, it's sharing joys, sharing sadness and supporting each other, as they say, in joy and in sadness, there you go. It's being there for each other.

Speaker1: [00:34:20] And you would say that it's important in a love relationship.

Speaker2: [00:34:24] There you go, it's important because it's. It's Love. Complicity. It's. I think one does not go without the other.

Speaker1: [00:34:35] One does not go without the other. You said it was also taking care of each other. Precisely, we know that there are different forms and ways of loving. I'd like you to tell me how you know your partner loves you. Your partner loves you.

Speaker2: [00:35:02] So I'm more. Well, it's regarding the difficulty all that. It's not necessarily the words the person says, but for me, it's mostly the gestures. There you go. And. On both sides. Well, of course, there are words but.

Speaker3: [00:35:24] Uh, it's.

Speaker2: [00:35:25] Mostly in.

Speaker3: [00:35:29] Uh.

Speaker2: [00:35:32] In the attentions that each other gives.

Speaker1: [00:35:37] So it's in the attentions. Attention, attentions. So what are these attentions?

Speaker2: [00:35:47] Being there for each other when needed. A moral support even. That's enough. It's a presence. It can be a phone call, it can be letters, writing to each other, it can be. Visits to our families. There you go, it's, it's. And especially not doing things you don't want to do.

Speaker1: [00:36:23] Not doing things you don't want to do.

Speaker2: [00:36:27] Not forcing the other to do things for example. Yeah. There you go, how can I force you. But you asked me to come with you and actually, I stopped doing that. The day you want to come with me, you'll come with me.

Speaker1: [00:36:49] I'd like you to tell me about one of the latest positive interactions you had with. With your partner.

Speaker2: [00:37:00] One of the latest that marked us, that was significant. Let's say one of the latest you think of.

Speaker1: [00:37:07] We talk about saving people, saving her daughter, saving my daughter. In the sense that we did everything. I spent [1-5] week in [City], at my daughter's place. She needed. Her technical control didn't pass. Her car, she went to the islands. She left me the mission of trying to find a way to make it pass by having everything repaired. Both of us managed to accomplish this mission and we know that. We know that when we are both, we can achieve a lot of things. It was after, there were still plenty of missions and even better. And there you go, we do it together.

Speaker1: [00:37:54] So do you have any recent, one of the latest negative interactions that you've had with your partner?

Speaker2: [00:38:08] Lately. I fix, I fix. That's the only negative point. Yes, it's that I haven't managed to get us together for now. And for me, that's what's negative. But sorry.

Speaker1: [00:38:28] You said, excuse me.

Speaker2: [00:38:30] It also teaches us. But well, after [1-5] years, I think we'll see the light at the end of the tunnel, so to speak. Yeah.

Speaker1: [00:38:37] So you don't have an example of an interaction that you had. That could have been negative. Even small ones.

Speaker2: [00:38:54] No, honestly, I can't think of any right now, no.

Speaker3: [00:39:02] I can't even brag about it.

Speaker2: [00:39:03] So no, for now there's.

Speaker1: [00:39:08] You just mentioned one of the difficulties that was a negative point, as you said, which was living together, being together. And I'd like you to tell me, in your opinion, what are the challenges to overcome in your relationship.

Speaker2: [00:39:23] Challenge to find, find housing. Which won't take long. Uh. After. Uh that her children and mine. Mine, it's a bit more achievable and achieved.

Speaker3: [00:39:47] But.

Speaker2: [00:39:53] That everyone manages to find their. A good balance and. So I know it's not necessarily a challenge because we already are, but there you go, that no one lacks anything, that. Oh yes, we have daughters, it's that we still haven't managed to really have our children meet. But we will get there.

Speaker1: [00:40:30] You haven't managed to.

Speaker2: [00:40:32] When we haven't managed to. We haven't managed to. If there is always something that we had to do Christmas together. Then it was canceled because of health reasons, etc. But we want to do. We will get there, we will get there. We will. We tell ourselves it wasn't the right time. There you go.

Speaker1: [00:40:56] Hum. Well, we know that sometimes, in a relationship, not everything is rosy. And I'd like you to tell me about the conflicts or disputes you can have with your partner.

Speaker3: [00:41:07] Less and less.

Speaker2: [00:41:08] We had at the beginning, as I was saying, not because of the children hum uh uh. It's mainly the fact that. I was saying that [Partner's Name], when she leaves her place, she feels she misses moments with her children. It could be a source of conflict at the beginning. When she talked about her children, I said I also have children and it's the same. Even if they are grown, it's just as important. There you go. So now, everyone is included, so there are no worries. Well, I mean, there you go. But now.

Speaker3: [00:41:54] We don't really have.

Speaker2: [00:41:54] A source of conflict now.

Speaker1: [00:41:59] I'd say for example that these conflicts or disputes that could have happened or can still happen over about [10-15] days, what would be their frequency?

Speaker2: [00:42:14] Once every [6-10] months.

Speaker1: [00:42:15] Once every [6-10] months. Hum hum. And so these conflicts that happen once every [6-10] months, their subjects are. Systematically. So you told me two things. You told me at the beginning the children and also the fact that. Well, especially that she felt she was missing time because it was always related to that. So how do you resolve these conflicts?

Speaker2: [00:42:49] Actually, it's the fact that I stayed almost at her place at the beginning, that we are not fixed on. Uh how to say, we don't do [Day] to [Day] if we have to stay uh even until [Day], it's no problem. That's it. I know that tomorrow we are both leaving because we both have to go to certain appointments, so I won't make her go back and forth. Well, it's more uh. Even if we have set certain things, how it's done. Well, it changes. It's not fixed. It's really, as I said, part of taking care of the other. Hum.

Speaker1: [00:43:48] So it's through attention, through the time spent. Through the communication you told me about at the beginning. At the beginning, you told me. You told me that taking care of the other was through communication, not turning your back. Are there other ways through which you maintain your relationship?

Speaker2: [00:44:16] Small attentions. After, yes, of course. But I know that I like to make surprises. Except I learned that [Partner's Name] doesn't like surprises, so I don't make surprises anymore. I tell her about them. Hum. It's. Uh. It's more her wishes that I see than mine actually. Hum. Uh and it's the same for her actually. There you go.

Speaker1: [00:44:46] In connection with what you were saying, maybe a bit earlier. You explained to me that now you are trying to do more things for yourself that you didn't think of doing before because you thought it was always things to be done together. For example, the poker you mentioned. It's something that precisely helped you maintain your relationship. Taking care of yourself?

Speaker3: [00:45:09] Exactly. Yes.

Speaker2: [00:45:11] It's important.

Speaker1: [00:45:12] Yes, it's important.

Speaker2: [00:45:14] Yes, because at the beginning, I kind of forgot myself. Yes, that's true. But then I wasn't necessarily happy. And then [Partner's Name] thought she was the one making me unhappy. So there you go, it's by talking. There you go. Yeah.

Speaker1: [00:45:29] Hum. I'd like to know what could make you leave your partner.

Speaker3: [00:45:40] Um.

Speaker2: [00:45:44] So the only thing that could make me leave her, uh, is for example if I was extremely ill and didn't want her to know. Hum.

Speaker1: [00:46:02] That's all.

Speaker3: [00:46:05] After that.

Speaker2: [00:46:06] No, I told her I would never leave you. If we separate, it's you who will make the decision. It won't be me. Yeah.

Speaker1: [00:46:17] Would you say this relationship is good for you? Oh yes? Yes yes. For example, functioning in [City]. It can be a good relationship, it can be a relationship that helps. In daily regulation. Functioning in dealing with everyday thanks to the partner or the relationship.

Speaker3: [00:46:38] Oh yes, completely.

Speaker2: [00:46:40] Oh yes, yes, absolutely.

Speaker1: [00:46:42] It can also be a relationship that helps achieve goals. You have words to say.

Speaker2: [00:46:53] Elevating the other. Actually, yes.

Speaker1: [00:46:56] Do you have examples of that?

Speaker2: [00:47:00] [Partner's Name] supported me a lot in projects I had. I didn't go through with them, as I said, because of health problems, but I know she was always there. There you go, and I hope I was there too for some things. I think, yeah.

Speaker3: [00:47:25] I think yes.

Speaker2: [00:47:27] After, she would be the one to say but.

Speaker1: [00:47:32] I'd like to know if you think you are the same person as before your current relationship. In other words, has the relationship changed you?

Speaker2: [00:47:41] I'm still the same person. No, I'm still the same person. It's like in poker. Even if it's free or paid, I always play the same way. I'm a person, on the other hand. Uh. Physically I have changed too. After all, there's age, but I have still lost weight. I have, I found my smile again. That's also important. I won't say that I. I didn't smile anymore but. I have found, yes, many things that I had kind of lost during the [6-10] years of a relationship that didn't necessarily bring me good things. Now, I'm still the same person.

Speaker1: [00:48:35] In the same way, would you say that your partner, your companion has changed during the. During the relationship compared to before the relationship. Has the relationship changed her?

Speaker2: [00:48:49] Because the relationship changed her? No, I don't think so.

Speaker3: [00:48:55] No.

Speaker2: [00:48:57] Sometimes she tells me, what she tells me already. That she asks herself more questions than before. It was.

Speaker3: [00:49:10] But from there.

Speaker2: [00:49:11] To change her character or anything, I don't think so actually. Even if she had obstacles in what she wanted to say. I always told her, speak with your heart. There you go.

Speaker3: [00:49:28] I don't think that.

Speaker2: [00:49:30] Well, no, because changing is not being yourself. And at some point, as they say, nature returns. And if the person loved you for certain character traits or and you forced yourself to be like that, at some point, it comes back out and it doesn't work anymore.

Speaker1: [00:49:50] You said you found your smile again.

Speaker3: [00:49:54] Yes.

Speaker2: [00:49:54] During those [6-10] years, I kind of lost it. Yes, yes. But actually, I wasn't happy for [6-10] years so there I still smiled but. Oh now, I smile more easily.

Speaker1: [00:50:26] Something like you said you don't change your way of playing poker. But in the way, maybe not in the way. How could we say that? How could we say that? This way you have of being the same, that you haven't changed, but still having things like you said, smiling again, at least more. These are still things that are significant on an individual level.

Speaker2: [00:50:55] After that, we shouldn't. Uh. We talked about it recently. There are people who, because they have had complicated trials in their life, will change their behavior a bit, hum hum, kind people who can become mean, etc. I think it's up to the person. Well, I don't know how to explain, I can understand, but. We are what we want to be. And I have always remained a good person, so on that I won't change. Hum. Okay.

Speaker1: [00:51:45] On that, you won't change on the fact of wanting to be a good person, right?

Speaker2: [00:51:49] Even if sometimes I want to be mean. No no no. But we have to. It's not about being mean, it's being angry with certain people. But uh.

Speaker3: [00:52:05] I, say I even.

Speaker2: [00:52:07] To my worst enemy. I don't wish them harm. Because I think we have other means. Uh. Uh. To fight, that is already by being happy. We show people that they can do nothing against that, right? So it's not worth it to take revenge, it's not worth it.

Speaker1: [00:52:41] Would you say you feel safe in this relationship?

Speaker3: [00:52:45] Completely. Completely.

Speaker1: [00:52:49] In what way?

Speaker2: [00:52:52] Because I know that.

Speaker3: [00:52:55] Uh.

Speaker2: [00:52:55] Yes, I fully trust her. I. Uh. I think we are really accomplices, that we really love each other, that it's sincere. Yes, I'm completely sure that we are accepted. After it's not a condition either, but I have never had a problem with that. With my children, I raised them. Well after they raise themselves, but I raised them in the way of without knowing anything, to be compassionate people, to be respectful, etc. All the values that uh, I tried to teach them because after that, as I say, they do what they want in their own way, uh in tolerance, etc. So there you go, I have never had any problems, even saying that I loved women, I never, I said it before being with someone even. So I announced it to everyone.

Speaker1: [00:54:03] Would you say for example that you can tell your partner everything, about your experiences, your thoughts, your identity, without fear of judgment and reprisal. Actually, would you say that feeling safe can also mean getting comfort or attention from the other in case of danger or distress?

Speaker3: [00:54:32] Yeah.

Speaker1: [00:54:34] Do you have examples of these. Of these two things.

Speaker2: [00:54:42] Do I have examples? I can't think of any right away like that. I just know that we trust each other, that we know we are there for each other, that uh, when I say each other.

Speaker3: [00:55:06] So we are there for each other.

Speaker2: [00:55:07] It includes our children and our family. I don't really have a concrete example right now.

Speaker1: [00:55:22] An example of a moment when. You were in difficulty or distress or danger and or. You brought comfort or attention?

Speaker3: [00:55:35] Yes, yes, dad, yes.

Speaker2: [00:55:37] When I started maybe an internship and she told me I had to stop to protect myself. Yes, absolutely.

Speaker1: [00:55:46] Because in the same way. So you think of an example where you could open up to your partner, about who you were, about your identity, your thoughts, your experience, your past. I felt.

Speaker3: [00:56:04] Anyway.

Speaker2: [00:56:04] Yes, she knows all my life and I think I know almost everything. We know in [1-5] years, you can't really know all the details but. I know there are things she can tell me that she has never told anyone.

Speaker1: [00:56:28] You too. Hum. I'd like to go back to something you talked about a bit earlier. We talked about disputes and conflicts that could happen in a couple. You told me it only happens every [6-10] months or about once every [6-10] months.

Speaker3: [00:56:48] There have been.

Speaker2: [00:56:49] A lot of them. Yes, yes, completely. There you go. I'm listening.

Speaker1: [00:56:58] Often in everyday social interactions, there can be small clashes like that, little things that are trivial. Does that happen to you too?

Speaker2: [00:57:11] Small clash.

Speaker1: [00:57:17] The small. I have the English world of small inconveniences.

Speaker2: [00:57:26] Yes, this inconvenience is part of it. After.

Speaker3: [00:57:36] Uh.

Speaker2: [00:57:38] Actually you confuse for now, so maybe there will be more, small inconveniences when we live together, but for now, there you go. Uh already I tell myself [1-5] week out of [1-5], I don't necessarily want there to be small inconveniences, even for a man. And then we don't really have reasons, really to. To have any. Well, for now. I I. I lived for ten years, even at the end of conflicted relationships. I know I don't like that at all, so I always looked to understand why and.

Speaker3: [00:58:17] How to say.

Speaker2: [00:58:18] Not to go to sleep angry. That's the thing. That's important and. Well, I don't really have.

Speaker3: [00:58:28] Uh no.

Speaker2: [00:58:30] Lately no. In any case.

Speaker1: [00:58:34] I understand. I understand what you are saying. Indeed, when you have a relationship where there were a lot of conflicts, well necessarily in the next one, you try not to repeat and you can even sometimes be in the avoidance of these conflicts because they are a sign, as you said yourself at the beginning of the interview, that potentially something is wrong. Is that something you think?

Speaker2: [00:58:59] Oh yes, absolutely. Besides, I don't know. Well, for [26-30] years, I had no conflict with my husband, really. And uh I feel bad when there is something that is not how shall I say. Solved, actually understanding why I don't want to remain in ignorance without knowing. Uh there you go. Because I don't say we can change people because I was sometimes asked in my life uh uh you have to change certain things, no we don't change, we make concessions, there you go. After the concessions shouldn't all be in the same direction, that there are not too many either because too many we are no longer ourselves. Uh there you go, I uh. From the moment there is love and that even if there are jokes, it's not done out of malice, it's just out of love. Uh when we don't think because [Partner's Name] often thought that I scolded her or uh.

Speaker3: [01:00:09] Inclusive.

Speaker2: [01:00:10] No, I am not your mother and I will never scold you, never scold my children. There you go, I explained to her that it's not possible, even if she thinks so. I said no, I will never scold you, never. I will never reproach you. Or then I will find a way to discuss. There you go, it's not a reproach, it's that the person doesn't suit you, not me, that's what I told my ex if it doesn't suit you, well we stop. We are not going to stay together. If if, we don't suit each other, we can't. As I say, fundamentally change people, it's something that bothers, it's either we accept from the start or we stay together. So no, for me conflicts are to be avoided.

Speaker1: [01:01:03] If I understand correctly what you are saying. Actually, for you, couple relationships and romantic relationships are the adequacy between two people who accept each other because it is not too unpleasant for them or because it is.

Speaker3: [01:01:16] Yes or.

Speaker2: [01:01:17] That it is as pleasant as possible.

Speaker3: [01:01:20] Yes.

Speaker1: [01:01:21] That's what I meant, accepting things that are unpleasant to them, that is, the reproaches are not enough. For that yes.

Speaker2: [01:01:31] Because well, it's clear, no one is perfect, so.

Speaker1: [01:01:35] No one is perfect.

Speaker3: [01:01:38] Nobody's perfect. Yeah.

Speaker1: [01:01:42] Well. I'd like us to now briefly address another constitutive dimension of couple relationships, sexuality. We know it can be a more or less important dimension in a relationship. What about you?

Speaker2: [01:01:55] So at first I thought it was half and half.

Speaker3: [01:02:03] Hum.

Speaker2: [01:02:04] Hum. After, given certain elements, uh, it's more the quality that will be important. Hum.

Speaker1: [01:02:13] The quality.

Speaker2: [01:02:15] The quality, yes.

Speaker3: [01:02:17] The quality.

Speaker2: [01:02:19] Uh, it's not about saying we make love three times a day, seven days a week that will make us love each other, no? Uh as I say, it's the quality, it's uh the desire, the need. Uh. After if there are no relations for a while, we can compensate with other things. Uh pleasant things. Hum. After if there is almost nothing at all, yes, you also have to ask questions. Hum. And it's more I. But more strength in it actually. Uh that I uh, that I thought before actually. There you go.

Speaker1: [01:03:09] Currently. Roughly, what would be the frequency of your sexual relations?

Speaker2: [01:03:15] Right now, not much, precisely because we have a lot of things to settle, because we are both tired. On the other hand, it's not necessarily that uh, it's also the tenderness that is important. There you go, tenderness is extremely important. So holding each other is just as important as making love.

Speaker3: [01:03:40] Hum hum.

Speaker2: [01:03:42] Lots of tenderness from time to time. Relationship yes, not necessarily very frequent for now. But there you go, it's. It's just a matter of time.

Speaker1: [01:03:57] Are you. Would you say you are satisfied with your sex life currently?

Speaker3: [01:04:02] Uh well.

Speaker2: [01:04:03] Never. We are never satisfied. But. Uh. I mean, for now, it's on one side and the other, it's. We have too many things on our minds. Actually, that's the problem.

Speaker1: [01:04:32] Too many things on the mind.

Speaker2: [01:04:36] We don't want to say we don't think about it. We talk about it, but. There you go, it's not a blockage for us anyway, it's not it's not a problem actually.

Speaker1: [01:04:55] I heard what you said. Hum. I'm going to show you a scale, I'm going to share my screen. I'd like you to answer it orally, so I'm going to share my screen right away.

Speaker3: [01:05:08] There you go.

Speaker1: [01:05:15] So tell me if you can see it correctly.

Speaker3: [01:05:24] Can I.

Speaker2: [01:05:24] Generally, my partner really listens to me.

Speaker1: [01:05:30] So generally, my partner really listens to me, so it goes from 1 to 9, 1 being not at all true and 9 completely true. Where would you place yourself.

Speaker3: [01:05:39] Seven, seven?

Speaker1: [01:05:40] Very true. So why seven?

Speaker2: [01:05:45] Because it's not totally. But more and more let's say. So it will only go up. How to say. Precisely, as I said, because we are preoccupied with something else, actually.

Speaker3: [01:06:02] And uh there you go.

Speaker2: [01:06:06] When she is focused on one thing, she is fully into it. And that's true for me too, but I have more, I won't say more capacity to listen anyway. Uh it's not it's not. I don't want to say she doesn't listen to me completely, but she is not yet really at 100%. That's why I put seven.

Speaker1: [01:06:30] You said we have other problems right now, what are you referring to? What are you thinking about?

Speaker2: [01:06:36] Housing, health. There you go, basically, that's it.

Speaker1: [01:06:42] Does that weigh on the relationship?

Speaker3: [01:06:43] Completely, yeah.

Speaker1: [01:06:48] Hum. But what's this weight?

Speaker2: [01:06:54] It's to move as quickly as possible. Okay.

Speaker1: [01:07:01] Hum. You answered that here? So why didn't you answer six for example? Or eight?

Speaker2: [01:07:08] Because I like seven in between because it says. Very true so.

Speaker1: [01:07:17] Hum. My partner is generally attentive to my needs.

Speaker2: [01:07:21] So there I can say uh, I can say nine.

Speaker1: [01:07:26] I can say nine. So why?

Speaker2: [01:07:30] Because she is really attentive to my needs.

Speaker1: [01:07:35] Hum. Why not eight?

Speaker2: [01:07:40] Because there, it's completely true. Very well.

Speaker1: [01:07:45] Uh. So how satisfied are you with your relationship? It goes from completely dissatisfied, very dissatisfied, rather dissatisfied. A certain other, rather satisfied, very satisfied, completely satisfied. Do you.

Speaker3: [01:07:58] Think.

Speaker2: [01:07:59] Precisely because we don't live together yet?

Speaker1: [01:08:01] Rather satisfied? So if you just answered in a linguistic form, if we switch it to a numerical form, where would you place yourself knowing that -10 would be completely dissatisfied and ten would be completely satisfied? And zero would be not at all satisfied or dissatisfied.

Speaker3: [01:08:25] Uh yes.

Speaker2: [01:08:30] I would put seven.

Speaker1: [01:08:32] I would put seven. Hum. So why not six or eight?

Speaker2: [01:08:41] Because. Because seven is in the high average and I don't have negative, but I don't have the complete positive. Yeah.

Speaker1: [01:08:51] So it's in the high average of.

Speaker3: [01:08:54] Of.

Speaker1: [01:08:56] Positive numbers, right? Okay. Hum.

Speaker3: [01:09:04] Listen.

Speaker1: [01:09:05] We are approaching the end of the interview. I thank you again for taking the time. Hum, what I am going to ask you. I'm just going to ask you two little things. I'm going to send you a link with a questionnaire that is quite short, it lasts about five to seven minutes max. Usually, that's what people take. So I would thank you for filling it out. And also, there is another thing I will ask for the study to work, so I don't know if you know. That's why normally it's information we provide, but I don't know if it has been provided. So I work in the context of an

international study on relational quality which is in several countries, in the Netherlands, Brazil, the United States. Well.

Speaker3: [01:09:45] You are in.

Speaker2: [01:09:45] [Location].

Speaker1: [01:09:47] I am in [Location], I am actually the [position] for the French part, so I take care of data collection for the French part. And so what we ask is we ask people we interview, so participants if they can not recommend other couples to us, but if they can recommend someone who could recommend other couples to us, that is, an intermediary, actually. Do you have someone in your circle who would be likely to take the time to think about couples who could participate?

Speaker3: [01:10:21] It doesn't have to be a gay couple.

Speaker1: [01:10:24] No, it doesn't have to be LGBT, no, no problem.

Speaker2: [01:10:27] Uh yes, yes, I can have people.

Speaker1: [01:10:34] There you go, you can take the time to think about it, send me an email later. The idea is that obviously you just inform them that I will contact them, then I take care of contacting them, explaining the purpose of the study, their role and then there you go. So tell me.

Speaker2: [01:10:53] Your questionnaire, will it be about interviewing 500 people?

Speaker1: [01:10:57] Or if you want, I'll stop the recording because we have finished the interview as such.